

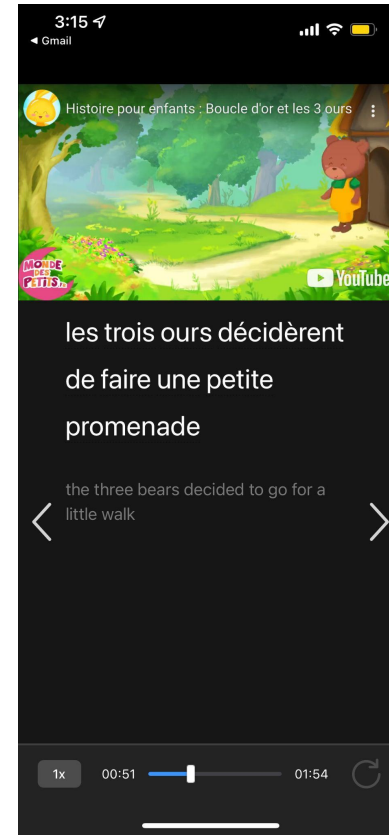
Spec: Duolingo Videos

Duolingo Take-home Assignment – Lan Nguyen

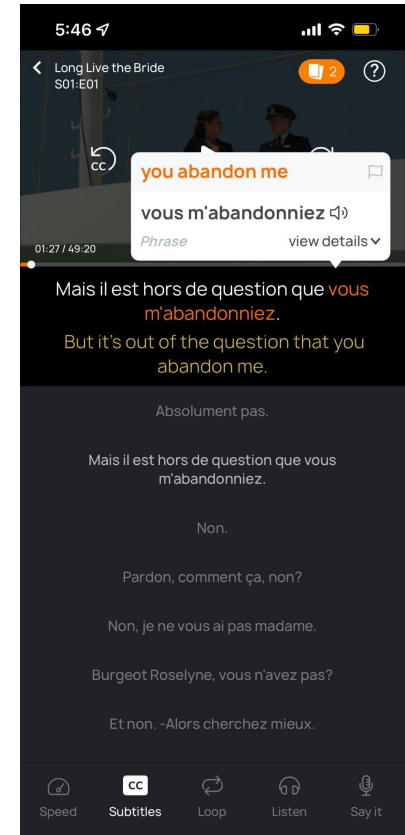


Background and Summary

- [Research](#) has shown that audio-visual input like TV and videos significantly helps second language acquisition via authentic language exposure.
- **Proposed Feature:** Duolingo Videos, an *animated* version of Duolingo Stories, where dialogues are replaced with interactive-subtitles videos and clips.
- **Hypothesis:** This new feature, offered only to Super subscribers (and limited free usage for Free users), will boost **conversion rate** from Free to Paid.
- **Competitive Analysis:** Many competitor language learning apps are based on this one feature alone: Lingopie, FluentU, Yabla,... -> evidence that this idea is bringing in profits.
- If Duolingo becomes the first to integrate interactive-subtitle videos with a structured learning path, **500,000+ paid MAUs** of competitor apps may convert to our app for an all-in-one language learning experience.
- **KPI:** Conversion Rate, expected impact +5%



FluentU



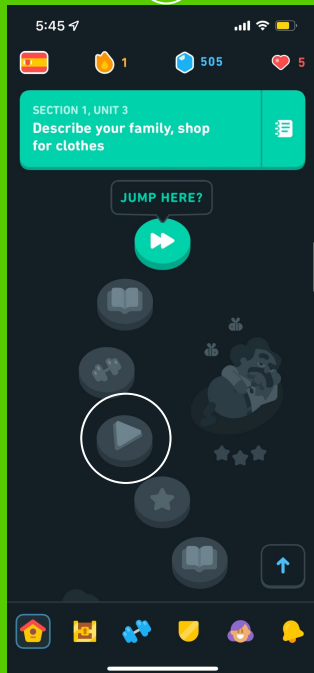
Lingopie

Design and Interaction - Entry Points

[Link to Figma](#)

For both Super and Free users, Video Lessons can be accessed via (1) the Learning Path, or (2) Bottom Menu -> Practice Hub -> Videos page (similar interface to that of Stories page).

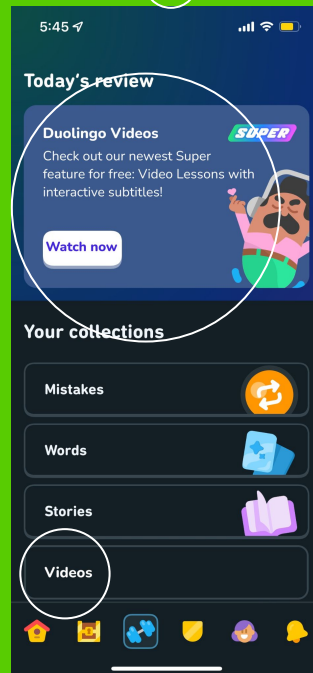
1



For Super subscribers:

- First, Video Lessons will replace 5% of normal and Stories lessons *earlier* on the Path for a testable sample.
 - Target most commonly studied languages like French and Spanish
 - Target early lessons to reduce content efforts and knowledge bias
- Video content will be:
 - P0: animated in-house
 - P1: contributed by a verified streaming service partner like Netflix

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For Free users:

- On Learning Path: Each normal lesson that can be replaced by a Video Lesson option will be indicated as such. Free users can try out ~ 3 free Video Lessons to decide if they want more. If not, continue learning normal lessons.
- In Practice Hub: CTA to try out (a limited number of) Video Lessons

Design and Interaction - Lesson Wireframes

[Link to Figma](#)



Must-haves

(in order of priority)

1. *Stories' upper navigation: exit, progress bar, hearts*
2. *Video player that automatically plays to start but can be paused/unpaused/skipped forward or backward by users*
3. *Interactive subtitles (same mechanism as Duolingo's current word click pop-up)*
4. *Translated subtitles*
5. *Question and answers*
 - a. *Questions should be a different format to those of Stories as the nature of videos usually gives the answers away*
 - b. *For now, just one overall question at the end about the gist of the video*
6. *Speed controller*
7. *Loop the current subtitle*

Nice-to-haves:

- Time-synced subtitle
- Add word to flash card option within pop-up
- Listen-up
- Say-it-out-loud Microphone

Execution

Risks & Conflicts	Proposed Solution
Users may find videos too boring and/or too long for Duolingo's signature bite-sized lessons	User research to understand (1) what kinds of content users like, (2) what the optimal length for a video should be (comparison testing with video-interactive platforms like TikTok) and adjust lessons accordingly. Further, a recommendation algorithm can be established to personalize videos to each user's interests and preferences.
Users may have a harder time understanding and remembering words when engrossed in a video	Before implementation, test replace 5% of regular lessons and evaluate results Video lessons should be structured to complement normal lessons (focusing on the same theme, having the same words, etc). Add-to-flash-card option will also be helpful for retaining information and spaced repetition.

Testing & Metrics:

To test my hypothesis, I would perform A/B tests by splitting Videos access amongst Free users, conduct user interviews / surveys, and track signals from public forums. All testings will be guided by the metrics below:

- **Success metrics:** conversion rate from Free users to Super subscribers
- **Feature metrics:** number of users starting Super free trial from this feature, how long they spend on each video lesson, how often they click on video lessons, how well they perform on follow-up questions, and how well they remember words mentioned in videos.
- **Guardrail metrics:** this feature may increase subscription revenue but, unless we take into account the risks & conflicts above, might harm users' engagement and current user retention